HARMONY · SLASH CHORDS · LEARN

Slash chords



REMEMBER Before the slash: the chord (right hand). After the slash: the bass, the lowest note (left hand).

1 Read the slash

★☆☆

Write the notes for each hand. The first row is done.

SYMBOL	RIGHT HAND (THE CHORD)	LEFT HAND (THE BASS)
C/E	C E G	E
G/B		
F/A		
Am/C		
D/F♯		

2 Inversion or colour?

★★☆

Is the bass a note of the chord (an inversion), or from outside it (a colour)? Circle one. The first is done.

C/G	(inversion) · colour
F/G	inversion · colour
G/B	inversion · colour
D/C	inversion · colour
Am/E	inversion · colour

3 Write the symbol

★☆☆

Chord first, then the slash, then the bass. The first is done.

CHORD	BASS	SYMBOL
C	G	C/G
G	D	
F	C	
Em	B	
F	G	

Date _____

HARMONY · SLASH CHORDS · USE

Slash chords

REMEMBER Walk-down: the bass steps down. Pedal: the bass stays. Colour: the bass is not in the chord.

1 Walk the bass down ★★☆

The bass walks C B A G F. Fill each gap with a slash chord: use the G chord once and the C chord once. The chord must hold the bass note.

Bass	C	B	A	G	F
Chord	C		Am		F

2 Over a C pedal ★☆☆

Write each chord over a C in the bass. The first is done.

Chord	F	G	Dm	B♭
Over C	F/C			

3 Left hand, right hand ★★☆

The left hand plays the note before the bar; the right hand plays the chord after it. Name it as a slash chord. The first is done.

LEFT HAND | RIGHT HAND	SYMBOL
E | C E G	C/E
B | G B D	
C | F A C	
G | F A C	
C | D F♯ A	

4 Play the walk and the pedal ★☆☆

Left hand plays the bass, right hand the chord. Tick a circle each clean day.

C G/B Am C/G F ○ ○ ○ ○

C F/C G/C C ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____